TIKO — Product Requirements Document (PRD)

1. Vision and overview

TIKO is a web app where people log habits, money and mood in under 30 seconds a day, and earn a treat they chose themselves whenever they hit a goal.

Most trackers fail because they ask for effort before they give any reward. TIKO flips that: logging is one tap, goals are small and preset, and every goal has a visible treat waiting at the end. The product loop is **Log, see progress, hit goal, claim treat**.

The first release is a responsive web app that installs to the home screen (PWA), so one codebase works on phone and laptop. Amounts use Indian rupees (Rs) by default; the app supports other currencies.

Module	What it tracks	Example goal	Example treat
Habits	Water, gym, steps, deep work, meditation, reading, custom habits	8 glasses of water daily for 7 days	A favourite coffee
Money	Daily spending, category budgets	Spend under Rs 500 a day for 5 days	Movie night
Mind	Mood check-in, gratitude, journal	5 journal entries this week	A long bath or a screen-free day
Savings	Money set aside toward a target	Save Rs 20,000 for a trip	Part of the savings spent guilt-free on one small thing

Brand note: the TIKO logo is a T built from five linked dots, the last one a ring. The same dot chain doubles as the streak indicator in the app.

2. Problem and target users

People who want better habits drop their trackers within weeks because logging feels like homework and nothing rewards them for sticking with it.

Problems we solve

- Logging takes too many taps, so people skip it on busy or low-energy days.
- One missed day breaks a streak and the user quits (the "what-the-hell" effect).
- Habits, spending and mood live in separate apps, so people never see how they connect.
- Rewards are vague or absent, so motivation fades.
- Money apps focus on guilt and limits, not on celebrating progress.

Primary users: students and working adults aged 18 to 35 who have tried habit apps before and abandoned them. They are comfortable on a phone, prefer low effort, and respond to small, concrete rewards.

Not for v1: detailed calorie logging, workout programming, or full personal-finance accounting. TIKO stays light on purpose.

Persona	Situation	Needs from TIKO
Aarav, 22, final-year student	Irregular sleep, skips gym, spends impulsively on food delivery	Tiny daily tasks, a spending cap with a treat, no guilt on missed days
Meera, 28, software engineer	Long desk hours, forgets water and steps, wants deep-work blocks and a savings habit	Step entry, a focus timer, a savings goal toward a trip
Rohan, 33, freelancer	Income varies, stress is high, journals rarely	Two-tap mood check-ins, a weekly money summary, a stress-aware tone

3. Goals, design principles and success metrics

TIKO succeeds if a lazy user still opens it on day 30; the clearest sign is that they logged something yesterday.

Design principles ("lazy-first")

1. One-tap logging. Any habit is logged from the home screen, under 3 seconds per entry.
2. Smart defaults. Preset goals, amounts and suggested treats so setup takes under 2 minutes.

3. Forgiving, not punishing. Streaks have a grace day; a miss never shows a red failure screen.
4. Reward early and often. A small celebration on every log, a bigger one on goal completion.
5. Show, don't ask. Pre-fill from yesterday and import data where possible.
6. Kind tone. Copy is warm and short, especially in the Mind module.

Goals for the first 6 months: daily check-in under 30 seconds for most active users; first claimed treat within 7 days of signup; a habit of coming back, not a one-time setup.

Metric	Definition	Target (to validate)
Activation	New users who log at least 3 entries on day 1	60%
First treat	New users who complete a goal in their first 7 days	40%
Day-7 retention	Users active on day 7 after signup	35%
Day-30 retention	Users active on day 30 after signup	20%
Median log time	Seconds from opening the app to the first logged entry	Under 10
Weekly logging days	Average days per week a user logs at least one entry	4 or more
Treat claim rate	Completed goals whose treat is marked claimed	70%

4. Habits, goals and treats

Every habit is one card on the home screen, and each card uses one of four tracking modes so logging is always a single gesture: tap counter, check-off, timer, or auto-sync.

Habit	Mode	Default daily target	Notes
Water	Tap counter	8 glasses (250 ml)	Quick-add for glass, bottle, large bottle

Habit	Mode	Default daily target	Notes
Gym / workout	Check-off	1 session	Weekly target such as 4 sessions
Steps	Manual entry or health-app import	8,000 steps	Web cannot read pedometers, so v1 uses manual entry
Deep work	Timer	90 minutes	25 or 50 minute focus blocks
Meditation	Timer or check-off	10 minutes	Optional 1, 5 or 10 minute breathing guide
Journal	Check-off, opens entry	1 entry	Links to the Mind module
Reading	Timer or page counter	20 pages or 20 minutes	Tracks current book

Custom habits: four fields (name, icon, tracking mode, daily or weekly target), set to "build" (do more) or "limit" (do less).

Habit rules: daily and weekly-target habits are both supported; the last 7 days can be edited; habits can be paused without breaking streaks; a new user starts with 3 suggested habits, not 15.

Goal types

Type	Meaning	Example
Daily target	Hit the daily amount	Drink 8 glasses today
Streak goal	Hit the target N days in a row (grace day allowed)	Meditate 7 days in a row
Weekly total	Reach a total across the week	Walk 50,000 steps this week
Count goal	Do it N times in a period	Gym 12 times this month
Limit goal	Stay under a cap	Spend under Rs 500 a day for 5 days

Type	Meaning	Example
Savings goal	Reach a saved amount by a date	Save Rs 20,000 by 31 March

Treats: a reward the user defines, with a name, optional photo, optional cost and a category. Free treats (an episode, a nap) and paid treats (coffee, a movie) are both supported; paid treats link to a treat budget so enjoying them never counts as overspending. The app suggests 30 starter treats sorted by cost and matches small treats to small goals.

Goal lifecycle

1. The user picks a template (for example "7-day water streak") or builds a goal in three fields: what, how much, by when.
2. The user picks a treat from the library or types one. Skipping the treat is allowed.
3. A progress ring appears on the home screen and the goal page.
4. At 50% and 90%, a short nudge appears ("Almost there").
5. On completion, a celebration screen shows the treat and a Claim button.
6. The user taps Claim after enjoying the treat; the goal moves to the Trophy shelf with a date.
7. The app offers to repeat the goal or raise it by about 10%.

Rules: treats are self-reported (honour system); a missed goal is never shamed, the app offers to extend, shrink or restart it; maximum 5 active goals; bundle goals can combine several habits for a bigger treat; one missed day per 7 does not break a streak, two in a row do.

5. Money, Mind and gamification

Money. A user logs a purchase in two taps, sees one "safe to spend today" number, and saves toward goals that end in a reward.

- Quick add: amount pad, then one category chip (Food, Transport, Bills, Shopping, Fun, Health, Education, Other). Date defaults to today; note is optional.
- "Same as last time" for repeat items; recurring items (rent, subscriptions, EMIs) entered once; optional income entries.
- A 10-second undo toast after every entry.

- One monthly budget plus optional category limits. Safe to spend today = remaining budget divided by days left.
- A soft warning at 80% of a category limit. No red alarm and no blocking. A "treat budget" category holds money set aside for rewards.
- Savings goals have a name, target amount, optional date and manual contributions, with treats at 25%, 50%, 75% and 100%. TIKO never holds, moves or links to money in v1.
- Weekly insight screen: spent vs budget, top 3 categories, biggest expense, comparison with last week, one gentle suggestion.

Mind. A two-tap daily mood check-in and an optional journal that connects mood to habits and spending.

- Check-in under 10 seconds: mood on a 5-point face scale, energy (low, medium, high), optional stress tag, up to three tags, optional one-line note.
- Journal: free write with auto-save, one guided prompt a day, gratitude mode (three lines), evening reflection (three taps), voice-to-text where the browser supports it. Entries are private by default and searchable.
- Self-care: box-breathing exercise (1 to 5 minutes), an editable "reset" list, and a low-mood mode that softens goals and hides streak counters after 3 low days.
- Insights: mood calendar heatmap; simple correlations after 14 or more days of data, worded as observations, never diagnoses.
- Mind rewards are for showing up (for example "5 check-ins this week"), never for feeling happy.
- Safety: TIKO is a self-care tool, not therapy or medical advice, and says so in onboarding and settings. If a user repeatedly logs very low mood or writes words suggesting self-harm, a calm card shows helpline information for their country and suggests talking to a trusted person. No diagnosis, no lockout. Journal data is never used for ads or shared. Export and delete are always available.

Gamification, streaks and reminders

Mechanic	How it works
XP and levels	Each log earns XP (water glass 1, workout 20, journal 15, mood check-in 5); friendly level names such as Sprout, Mover, Steady, Champion

Mechanic	How it works
Forgiving streaks	One grace day per 7; a streak-freeze token earned every 14 days
Daily ring	One ring on Today fills as habits complete; closing it earns a bonus
Trophy shelf	Every completed goal and claimed treat, stored with date and photo
Badges	About 25 in v1 (first log, 7-day streak, first savings milestone, 30 journal entries)
Weekly recap	Sunday card: days logged, goals hit, treats earned, money saved, mood trend
Mystery treat (optional)	A random small treat from the user's own list after a perfect week

Reminders: at most 2 a day, quiet hours default 10 pm to 8 am, smart timing 30 minutes before the user's usual log time, tone options (gentle, playful, minimal), one friendly re-engagement message after 3 days away then silence for a week. Web push needs permission; email is the fallback.

Game principles: never remove points or show negative scores; no public comparison or leaderboard in v1; users can hide streak numbers.

6. Flows, architecture, requirements, roadmap and risks

Onboarding (under 2 minutes): sign up with email or Google, or try as a guest; pick 3 starter habits; pick one starter goal; pick its treat; set reminder time and tone (permissions asked only now); land on Today with the first card ready to tap.

Navigation: five tabs.

Tab	Contains	Purpose
Today	Habit cards, daily ring, safe-to-spend card, mood check-in, wrap-up	Log everything in one place
Goals	Active goals, goal builder, treat library, Trophy shelf	Set goals and claim treats

Tab	Contains	Purpose
Money	Expense list, quick add, budget, savings goals, weekly insights	Spend and save
Mind	Mood calendar, journal, breathing tool, insights	Reflect and care for yourself
Me	Profile, habit library, reminders, export, privacy, help	Control and customise

Architecture: a Next.js PWA talks over HTTPS and JSON to one Node.js REST API with four modules (Habits, Money, Mind, and a shared Goal engine). The API reads and writes PostgreSQL and uses a job scheduler (nightly rollups, streak grace), a managed auth service (magic link, Google) and push/email for reminders and recaps. The Goal engine checks goals after every log so a treat unlocks the moment a target is met.

Layer	Choice
Front end	React, TypeScript, Next.js, Tailwind CSS
State and offline	TanStack Query plus an IndexedDB queue
Backend	Node.js with TypeScript (NestJS or Fastify), REST
Database	PostgreSQL
Auth	Email magic link and Google via a managed service
Jobs	Queue and scheduler (for example BullMQ)
Notifications	Web Push plus transactional email

Core data model: User, Habit, HabitLog, Goal, Treat, Expense (integer minor units), Budget, SavingsGoal, MoodEntry, JournalEntry (encrypted body), Reward/XP event.

Non-functional requirements

Area	Requirement
Privacy	Journal and mood data encrypted at rest; never sold or used for ads

Area	Requirement
Security	HTTPS, secure sessions, rate limiting, monthly backup tests
User control	Full export (CSV and JSON); account deletion removes data within 30 days
Performance	Home interactive in under 2 s on a mid-range phone over 4G; log confirmed under 300 ms
Offline	Logging works offline and syncs later; latest edit wins per entry
Accessibility	WCAG 2.2 AA, reduced motion, 48 px tap targets
Compatibility	Latest two versions of Chrome, Safari, Edge, Firefox; 360 px width and up
Compliance	Review India's DPDP Act 2023 and GDPR before launch (legal review recommended)
Scale	50,000 users on a single database before re-architecture

Content and tone: never shame ("Want to adjust this goal?" not "You failed"); no medical, diet or investment advice; treats are never food-only.

Roadmap (estimates for a team of 2 to 3; stretch if building solo)

Release	Weeks	Scope	Gate to continue
MVP	1 to 8	Today screen, 7 core habits, goals, treats, trophy shelf, expense add, monthly budget, mood check-in, simple journal, streak grace, daily reminders	10 beta users log 4+ days a week
V1	9 to 16	Savings goals with milestones, weekly money and mood recap, guided journal and breathing, custom treats with photos, health-app step import, Free and Plus plans	Day-30 retention at or near 20%

Release	Weeks	Scope	Gate to continue
V2	17 to 26	Native wrapper for steps, Hindi and more languages, accountability buddy, smart goal suggestions, coach-led challenges	None

Monetization: core experience stays free; no ads, no data sales. Prices are hypotheses to test.

Plan	Includes	Price idea
Free	Up to 5 habits, 2 active goals, basic money log, mood check-in, basic journal	Rs 0
Plus	Unlimited habits and goals, savings goals, insights, health-app import, custom treats with photos, export, themes	Rs 149 a month or Rs 999 a year

Analytics: track events only (habit_logged, goal_created, goal_completed, treat_claimed, expense_added, mood_logged, reminder_opened) and funnels (signup, first log, first goal, first treat, day-7 return). Never send journal text or exact amounts.

Risks

Risk	Likelihood	Mitigation
Users stop logging after 1 to 2 weeks	High	Forgiving streaks, tiny goals, smart reminders, weekly recap
Web cannot read steps automatically	High	Manual entry in v1, health-app import in v1.1, optional native wrapper later
Feature creep across four modules	High	Strict MVP scope, one shared engine, cut anything that adds logging steps
Treats encourage overspending or unhealthy food	Medium	Treat budget, non-food suggestions, proportional rewards
Mental-health content misread as therapy	Medium	Disclaimers, helpline card, no diagnosis, expert copy review

Risk	Likelihood	Mitigation
Web push unreliable on some browsers	Medium	Email fallback and in-app reminders
Sensitive data breach	Low but severe	Encryption, minimal data, security review before launch

Open questions: final brand name check (trademark and domain for "TIKO"); whether Plus pricing suits the target users; light theme only or light and dark for v1 (the Design Doc plans both).